# BRICS, G20 & THE GLOBAL SOUTH

## FORGING A PATH TO A SHARED HUMANITY

**Cole Jackson with Chloé Maluleke and Sesona Mdlokovana,**
**Lead Associate and Associates, BRICS+ Consulting Group**

In a time of global uncertainty, the call for a fairer world order has never been louder. Traditional systems of cooperation remain dominated by a minority of industrialised nations. The BRICS alliance, G20, and the rise of the Global South could reshape that narrative. Together, they represent a shift toward a multipolar world grounded in shared humanity, dignity, and inclusive development.

**BRICS**

BRIC (Brazil, Russia, India and China) was established in 2009, with the explicit aim of reforming global governance and encouraging economic cooperation among emerging powers. Its foundational ethos is one of equality and mutual respect, a stark contrast to the weighted voting systems of traditional institutions, like the UN Security Council. South Africa joined in 2010. The organisation continues to expand, now consisting of 10 official member states.

By ensuring all member states have equal decision-making authority, regardless of economic size, BRICS models a form of partnership built on solidarity rather than subordination.

The creation of the New Development Bank (NDB) in July 2015 is a tangible manifestation of this principle, offering an equitable alternative to the International Monetary Fund (IMF) and World Bank for development financing. While the bloc faces challenges in coordinating its diverse economies and navigating a dollar-dominated system, its very existence and continued expansion signal a decisive move towards a world where a plurality of voices can shape their own destinies through collective progress in trade, technology, and social development.

To foster a more equitable global financial system, BRICS is encouraging bilateral trade in members' national currencies. Concurrently, the bloc is holding preliminary conversations about implementing a shared BRICS currency, a project still in its early stages.

**Group of 20 (G20)**

The G20, representing close to 85% of global GDP and 75% of international trade, holds immense structural power to reshape global governance. Its greatest test today, however, lies not in finance, but in fairness. For decades, its policy decisions have disproportionately reflected the priorities of industrialised nations, often treating the Global South as a junior partner. This imbalance is no longer sustainable.

A reformed G20, one that genuinely amplifies voices from the South and integrates social and environmental justice into its core economic agenda, could become the moral bridge between global influence and global inclusion. By building consensus beyond mere GDP metrics and prioritising coordinated action on debt and climate finance, the G20 can demonstrate that shared humanity begins with shared power. It stands at a crossroads: to reform and become a truly representative forum, or risk irrelevance in a world that is no longer waiting for an invitation to the table.



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**The Global South**

The Global South is not a monolith but a diverse collective at a crucial historical moment. It is increasingly promoting a vision for global governance that prioritises shared humanity over existing hierarchies. With over 85% of the world's youth, abundant resources, and rapid technological advancements, it possesses immense potential for sustainable development.

Increased South-South cooperation and innovative financing demonstrate a move towards greater independence. However, persistent obstacles – crippling debt, the existential threat of climate change, and the digital divide – require a unified response. The dual challenge for the Global South is to harness its collective economic and demographic power while simultaneously advocating for the democratisation of financial, trade, and technological systems on the global stage.

The intertwined paths of BRICS, the G20, and the Global South are shaping a new global vision. BRICS demonstrates cooperative governance; a reformed G20 integrates it into the global economy; and the Global South provides the demographic, economic, and moral drive for change. Together, they have the potential to shift the world from a hegemonic order to one of dignified interdependence, building a truly representative and accountable multilateral system for all humanity.